MISS PELL'S CASE OF THE WEEK · NO. 4

The Answer: By the Bonfire

Here is the case again, and then its answer one deduction at a time, with a picture of the plan after each step. In the pictures, **yellow** squares are where the suspect in question could still be, **red crosses** are what that step has just ruled out, and **initials** mark suspects already placed.

By the Bonfire

STANDARD

SOLVED STEP BY STEP ON THE FOLLOWING PAGES



The first Friday of November, and the bonfire was still burning. When the lamps came back on, Walter lay in the Butler's Pantry.

THE CLUES

1. Martin was two rows north and one column east of Violet.
2. Bernard could see the bonfire.
3. Frank shared an area with someone who was beside the bonfire.
4. Robin was north of Grace.
5. Grace was not beside a table.
6. Violet was on the Lawn.

GENERAL CLUES

7. Everyone beside the bonfire, if anyone, wore a bowler.

THE SUSPECTS



1. Martin
a fedora
a beard



2. Bernard
spectacles
a beard



3. Frank
spectacles
a beard



4. Grace
a bowler
a monocle



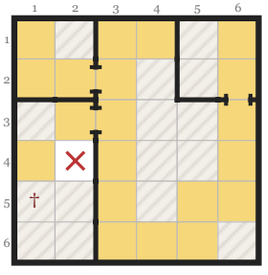
5. Robin
a fedora
spectacles
a beard



6. Violet
a bowler
spectacles

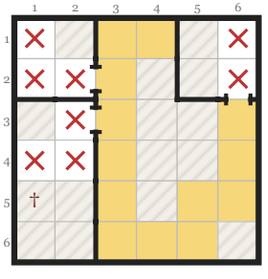
THE MURDERER

The answer, step by step

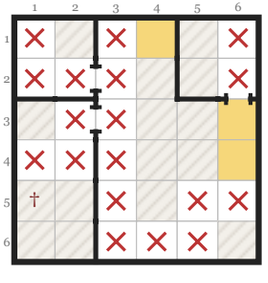


1 Clue 5: Grace has 20 squares left.

> **Ruling out.** A statement that says where a guest was not is still a statement: cross those squares off.

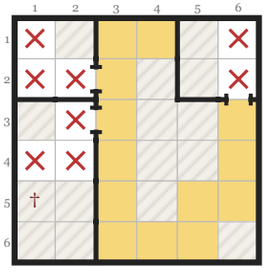


2 Clue 6: Violet must be on the Lawn.

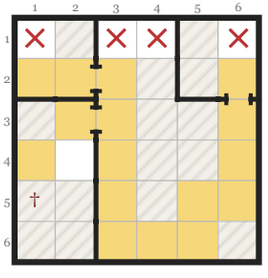


3 Clue 1: Martin must be on the Lawn, and Violet must be on the Lawn.

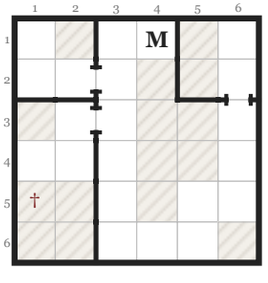
> **Two guests at once.** A statement about two guests limits both. Wherever one of them cannot be, the other's options shrink too.



4 Clue 3: Frank must be on the Lawn.

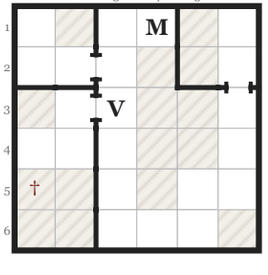


5 Clue 4: Grace has 16 squares left, and Robin has 18 squares left.

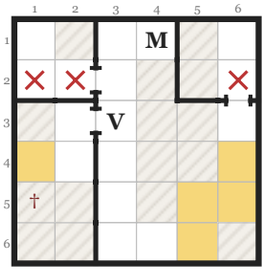


6 Clue 7 settles it: Martin is at R1C4.

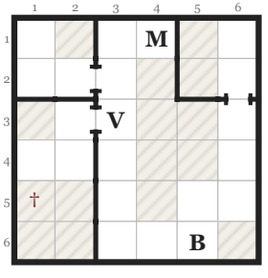
> **What they wore.** Statements about hats, spectacles, monocles and beards refer to the lineup. Work out who they can be about first, then where.



7 Clue 1 settles it: Violet is at R3C3.

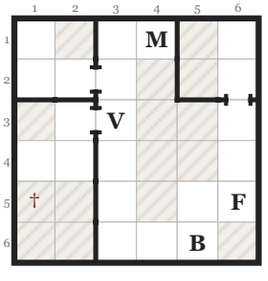


8 Clue 4: Grace has 5 squares left.



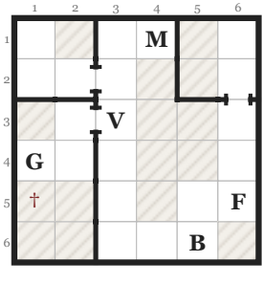
9 Clue 2 settles it: Bernard is at R6C5.

> **Lines of sight.** A guest sees along their row and column, never diagonally, until a wall or an outlined piece blocks the view. Check each square they might use.

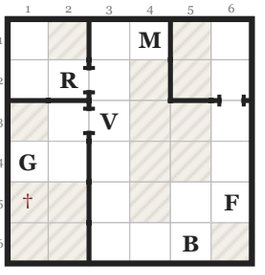


10 Frank has only one square left: R5C6.

> **One square left.** When everything else has been ruled out for a guest, the square that remains is theirs.



11 Grace has only one square left: R4C1.



12 Only one square is left for Robin, so Robin is at R2C2.

With the grid full, only Grace was in the Butler's Pantry with Walter. Grace is the murderer.

The next case

Every Friday, Miss Pell posts a new case at **whereaboutspuzzles.com**. Fifty more are in her ledger, **Whereabouts: Murder Sudoku — 50 Murder Mysteries from Ashcombe Manor**, from spring to winter.